

Diana (1894) as a Symphony and a Coming Out

Overture

But, how lucky we had been to love! Or similarly:
 I dreamt of you next to the statue of Diana
 at the Met. She is caught in arabesque atop a marbled pillar
 in Bronze

Arrow drawn back; Anticipation. In music,

An anticipation waits for the arrival of
 the next chord.

It does not strike the notehead and peel it in two

Like the hemispheres of a globe. Diana

once rotated atop a building, scratching a line
 in the sky's chest with the end of her arrow.
 You

have never known the silver-lipped, flutter-tongued palms
 of clouds, nor

how to draw your heart against the sky as if your

Love could be used as a weapon, nor how to

interject queerness

in direct modulation so that shock accounts for the way

Nothing can be said for what you have because
 done.

How you have loved.

Coda

Diana was the artist's only female nude. He saw her body
 shining, yolk-yellow,

hunting the sun and breathing against the moon, with
 deliberation.

I see you unthinkingly, clumsily
 in this dream

Because I did not mean to— A grace note. Slight.

And you have never known that you

are still standing next to Diana at the Met and

I am stood beside you, and

her bronzed arrow is dotting a line between our arms, arms
 brushing together like

bossa nova drums underscoring the

shame that pours into the cast of who we are, because

You did not mean to

love me nor

to sculpt me nor to

breathe against my cheek,

because

we do not end like a picardy third, because

Leitmotif

You do not know how to see my body shining, while my heart trills on scalloped contrails

and imagine: a Diana

Without dreaming of the dinner table where you told your mother you loved a girl

And she quietly started to weep—